

PUSHKAR KUMAR

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EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee, India
BS-MS Physics

2023 – 2028

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant | KU Leuven

August 2026 – Present

Mentor: Weihong Wang, PhD Researcher at KU Leuven, Belgium

- Exploring **low-resource blockchain validator protocols**, focusing on state sharing, uneven node storage, incentive layers and 1-to-n payment channel designs.

Research Collaboration | Remote Independent Research

July 2026 – Present

Mentor: Dr. Deepak Kumar, Postdoc at KDDI Research Inc., Japan

- Exploring **test-time adaptation** for **speech and multimodal emotion recognition**, focusing on robustness under speaker, domain and modality shifts.

Research Intern | QIntern 2026 (QWorld)

July 2026 – August 2026

Mentor: Abhishek Sawaika, PhD at University of Melbourne, Australia

- Selected for the international **QIntern 2026** research program to develop a **network-aware orchestration and simulation tool** for **distributed quantum computing**.
- Developing and extending the open-source **iQuantum** simulator in **Java**, integrating quantum networking, distributed resource orchestration, interactive visualization, and execution of quantum programs across networked processors.

Summer Research Intern | Physics Department, IIT Roorkee

May 2026 – July 2026

Supervisor: Prof. Mayank Goswami

- Worked on **Computed Tomography (CT)** image reconstruction using **Deep Learning** techniques for accurate reconstruction of medical images from projection data.
- Implemented and experimented with **Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)** and physics-inspired reconstruction pipelines using **PyTorch** for medical imaging applications.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

LLVM Compiler Infrastructure

[Repository](#) | [Pull Requests](#)

PROJECTS

RISC-V ISA Simulator | C++ | Computer Architecture | [github](#)

July 2026 – Present

- Building a modular **RV32I ISA simulator** in **C++** to model instruction execution across **single-cycle**, **multi-cycle** and **5-stage pipelined** processor models.
- Developing core architecture components including **instruction decoding**, **register file simulation**, **byte-addressed memory**, **ALU execution**, **program-counter control**, **cache behavior** and **trace-based debugging**.

UniCloak | DeFi | ZK | Cross-Chain | [github](#)

Dec 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built a **zero-knowledge privacy layer** for stablecoin transactions, private swaps, bridging, and cross-chain swaps from a **unified liquidity pool** on **Mantle mainnet**; designed **Noir circuits** for zk-ID, wallet commitments, deposits, and withdrawals.
- Implemented **Solidity** contracts for an identity mixer, private pool, verifier contracts, and a Base **CrossMessenger**; integrated **WooFi**, **Stargate**, a **Node.js relayer**, and an off-chain **Merkle proof** manager to execute private DeFi actions without exposing user wallet identity.

- Built an **AI-orchestrated crypto-to-fiat checkout** where **Claude Desktop** coordinates Merchant, Relayer, and Sei Wallet **MCP** servers to discover products, create **Stripe PaymentIntents** and complete purchases from natural-language prompts.
- Implemented an **escrow flow** using a **Locker smart contract**, on-chain Locked events, Stripe payment verification, resolver settlement and receipt notifications so user funds remain escrowed until fiat payment finality is proven.

- Built a **tokenized U.S. stocks** protocol on **Avalanche Fuji**; used **Chainlink Functions** and **Chainlink Price Feeds** to fetch stock prices, convert AVAX/USD values, and execute mint/redeem flows backed by off-chain **Alpaca API** orders.
- Added **Chainlink CCIP** support for cross-chain USDC mint/redeem requests from Sepolia to Avalanche Fuji, and connected an **ElizaOS** agent that checks balances and initiates stock purchase or redemption transactions through natural-language wallet commands.

AWARDS / SCHOLARSHIPS / ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENTS

- **First Prize** worth \$10,500 in the **ElizaOS** track at the **Chainlink Chromion Hackathon**.
- **Second Prize** worth **Rs. 75,000** in the final round of the **TriHacker Hackathon** by The Residency – Bangalore House.
- **Second Prize** worth **Rs. 25,000** in the first round of the **TriHacker Hackathon** by The Residency – Bangalore House.
- **AgentKit Pool Prize** winner at the **Agentic Ethereum** hackathon.
- Selected in the **Top 30 Projects** for Demo Day at the **Mantle Global Hackathon**.
- Selected as one of **38 developers** out of 581 applicants in **PLDG Cohort-4** to contribute to the **Protocol Labs** ecosystem.
- **All India Rank 8,950** in **JEE Advanced 2023**.
- **98.57 Percentile** in **JEE Main 2023**.

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY & EXTRA CURRICULARS

- Student-led **blockchain** community at **IIT Roorkee** focused on **Web3** research, developer collaboration, workshops, and technical meetups.